LEARN · GRAMMAR

A2

Irregular Verbs



Many of the most common English verbs don't follow the regular -ed pattern in the past. There's no shortcut — they just have to be learned, usually in small groups by pattern.

WHICH COLUMN, WHERE?

BASE	PAST SIMPLE	PAST PARTICIPLE
go	**went**	**gone**
see	**saw**	**seen**
eat	**ate**	**eaten**

PAST SIMPLE
Yesterday I went.

have / has / had
I have gone.

✗ I have went there. · He has ate already.
✓ I have been there. · He has eaten already.

1 Some very common ones

base → past simple → past participle

go → went → gone	**eat** → ate → eaten	**see** → saw → seen
buy → bought → bought	**take** → took → taken	**write** → wrote → written
break → broke → broken	**come** → came → come	**give** → gave → given
find → found → found	**know** → knew → known	**think** → thought → thought

2 Patterns that make them easier

All three forms the same
put → put → put · cut · cost

Past simple = past participle
buy → bought → bought · find · think

All three forms different
go → went → gone · see · take

3 Where you'll meet them

Past simple uses the **middle form**. Present perfect uses the **last form**, with have/has/had.

- Yesterday I **went** to the shops (not 'goed').
- I have never **seen** that film (not 'seed' or 'saw').

4 Common mistakes

✗ She buyed a new phone.	✓ **She bought a new phone.**	irregular past form
✗ They have took the bus.	✓ **They have taken the bus.**	3rd form after have/has

APPLY · PRACTICE

A2

Irregular Verbs Practice

A Choose the correct word

1. Yesterday she ___ to school late. **(goed / went / gone)**
2. She has ___ that film three times. **(saw / see / seen)**
3. I have never ___ to Japan. **(been / went / goed)**
4. She ___ me everything I needed to know. **(teached / taught / telled)**
5. He ___ his umbrella on the train yesterday. **(leaved / left / leaves)**
6. I have never ___ so much coffee in one day. **(drank / drink / drunk)**

B Complete with the verb in brackets

1. The children ___ (fall) asleep on the sofa.
2. Who ___ (steal) my sandwich?!
3. The baby ___ (sleep) for twelve hours.
4. They ___ (take) the wrong bus and got lost.
5. We ___ (drive) to the beach on Saturday.
6. She has already ___ (choose) tonight's special.

C Find and fix the mistake

1. He breaked the window by accident.

   _____

2. We taked the wrong bus and got lost.

   _____

3. They have never feeled so proud.

   _____

4. They have rode their bikes to school every day this week.

   _____

5. He finded his wallet under the sofa cushions.

   _____

6. He payed for everyone's dinner last night.

   _____

D Complete the table

BASE	PAST SIMPLE	PAST PARTICIPLE	BASE	PAST SIMPLE	PAST PARTICIPLE
write			**steal**		
drive			**swim**		
choose			**fly**		

E Speak

say it out loud with a partner

1. Tell a partner about your last holiday using at least five irregular past simple verbs.
2. Tell a story about something that went wrong using irregular verbs.
3. Use 'fell', 'broke', 'lost', and 'forgot' in a short story.